

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 10 8 7

♥ 6 5 4

♦ Q J 3

♣ K 4

♠ 9 3 2

♥ A J 7

♦ A 4

♣ Q J 8 7 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 6 5

♥ Q 9 8 2

♦ 10 8 7 6 2

♣ 5

♠ K 4

♥ K 10 3

♦ K 9 5

♣ A 10 9 6 2

West	North	East	South
			1 ♣
1 ♠	2 ♠	Pass	3 ♣
Pass	5 ♣		
All Pass			
5 ♣ by South			

North's cue-bid shows a limit raise or better (11 points) in ♣s. South is to play 5♣. West leads the ♠Q, East takes the ♠A and returns the ♠6 to your ♠K.

You have lost one trick already and have a possible loser in trumps and another possible loser in ♥s. Both losers can be avoided with successful finesses. The problem with the ♣ finesse is that West made an overcall so he is more likely to hold the ♣K. If you don't try the ♣ finesse you may be able to throw a defender in with the ♣K at a time when he will have to help you with his next play.

After winning the ♠K immediately play the ♣A.

It would have been nice to see the ♣K fall, but it didn't. So play a small ♦ to dummy's ♦A and play the ♠9, ruffing in your hand.

Eliminate the ♦s by playing ♦K, then ruffing your last ♦ in dummy.

You have done all the eliminating, time to throw in somebody. Play a ♣.

Whichever defender had the ♣K is now on lead, but wishes he wasn't. If he plays a ♥ you get a free finesse. If he plays anything else you get a ruff-sluff.

If you had finessed for the ♣K West would have won the trick and been able to make a safe exit, probably with his other ♣.

You would then have been forced to rely on the ♥ finesse, and with West being the defender who showed some strength, you would likely have finessed through him.

About the only way the elimination/throw-in could fail is if the ♣s split 3-0. Then, if you play Ace and another the defender who wins would use his third ♣ as a safe exit.

Board 3

West Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q 10 3

♥ 2

♦ 10 8 7 2

♣ K J 5 4

♠ A 8 6 2

♥ A 10 9 6

♦ A K

♣ 7 6 3



♠ J 9 7 4

♥ 8

♦ J 9 6 4 3

♣ 9 8 2

♠ 5

♥ K Q J 7 5 4 3

♦ Q 5

♣ A Q 10

West	North	East	South
Pass	1NT	Pass	3♥
Pass	4♥	Pass	5♣
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			

6♥ by South

Conveniently in dummy, you play a ♣ and insert the ♣10 if East plays low.

[showcards N:HA,H6,C7,C6 S:HK,HQ,CA,CQ]

West will probably win this trick. If he wins with the ♣K then your hand is good. If he wins with the ♣J then he is end-played, forced to either lead a ♣ into your ♣ A Q or to give you a ruff-sluff.

You probably noticed that you could have finessed your ♣Q on the first ♣ play and pulled off the end-play just as effectively. But there is an advantage to making the first finesse with the ♣10.

If East just happens to hold both the ♣K and ♣J you will make all thirteen tricks if your first finesse is with the ♣10!

Your 3♥ bid is a slam suggestion. After you show the ♣A partner wastes no time in bidding it.

South is to play 6♥. West leads the ♠K.

This is a good slam. You have only two possible ♣ losers, and by taking two ♣ finesses you have an excellent chance of success. But by using an elimination play you will have a sure thing.

Win the ♠A and ruff a ♠ with a ♥ honor.

Play a small ♥ to dummy's ♥9 and ruff another ♠. Both defenders followed to the trump play.

Play another ♥ to dummy's ♥10 and ruff the last ♠.

Play the ♦A and ♦K.